JASON A. RUSSELL

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SUMMARY

I help manufacturing plants run better by getting the right people talking, making problems visible, and building systems that make the right way the easy way. Over 12 years I've worked in continuous-web roofing production, investment casting, and firearms manufacturing, leading lean and CI work, supply chain system rollouts, and frontline problem solving grounded in Shingo principles.

HIGHLIGHTS

- De facto site lead for a Körber WMS migration from two legacy systems, recognized by senior supply chain leadership as the company's smoothest WMS rollout
- Led a global team (GAF, Grace, BMI; three countries) to win the Standard Industries Digital Academy pitch, judged by C-level executives
- Cut a major scrap category by more than half, reducing total plant scrap by about 10%
- Formally trained about 100 employees in structured problem solving and lean methods

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Business System Specialist April 2023 – Present

Siplast (GAF / Standard Industries) | Arkadelphia, AR

- Körber WMS migration: coordinated warehouse, quality, and production teams with no shipping supervisor or supply chain manager in place; ran a wall-to-wall physical inventory before cutover, built poka-yoke error-proofing into new workflows, and trained about 30 users
- Led a scrap reduction initiative targeting wet-sheet defects (with a secondary reduction in sticking), cutting that category by more than half and total plant scrap by about 10%
- Transformed Tier 0 and Tier 1 of the plant's LDM/SQDCE tiered daily management from a compliance exercise into a working problem-solving system, expanded it across departments, and rolled out the plant-level board and process
- Implemented hour-by-hour boards for operators and partnered with site leadership on Leader Standard Work for production supervisors
- Doing Bill of Materials work for the site's SAP readiness; helped the lab and supply chain define the returned-material (RMA) process
- Ran a week-long MRO inventory overhaul with a 26-person cross-functional team, cataloging 3,000+ items and raising system coverage from 40% to nearly 100%
- Built frontline 5S audits and a dual-track safety audit for operators and leadership; used FMEA to structure shift-by-shift safety-culture events
- Got R&D and plant operations, separated by a parking lot, communicating regularly so trials became jointly coordinated
- Lead the FORCE employee-engagement program; supervise two employees in the pallet mill

Team Leader / Continuous Improvement Specialist February 2014 – April 2023

Sturm, Ruger & Co. | Newport, NH

- Led a team of 12–15, including performance reviews, running the investment casting "super cell": wax injection, shell building, foundry, and initial processing
- Improved foundry throughput from 15–16 to 17–18 parts per hour with the team, reaching the bottleneck limit (a 10–15% gain)
- Twice recognized with the CEO's Discretionary Award for continuous improvement contributions (2017, 2023)
- The site's go-to resource for small-scale improvement, with hands-on time across casting, machining, finishing, assembly, test, and packaging

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- Store Manager, Dollar Tree, New Hampshire (2012–2013; promoted from Assistant Manager)
- Field Representative, WW Feed & Supply, La Junta, CO (2010–2011)

EDUCATION

- B.S., Supply Chain and Operations Management, Western Governors University (2026)

TRAINING & CREDENTIALS

- Shingo Institute alumni: all six workshops (2025)
- Six Sigma certification, Aveta Business Institute
- Statistical Process Control training, GAF

SKILLS

- **Continuous improvement:** Lean, Kaizen, 5S, Root cause analysis (6M), FMEA, Value stream mapping, Visual management, Tiered daily management, Leader Standard Work
- **Systems and supply chain:** Körber WMS, SAP readiness and BOM structure, Inventory accuracy and MRO, Kanban and replenishment
- **People:** Training and facilitation, Cross-functional coordination, Employee engagement, Change management